

VARSHA SATHYANARAYANAN

Category Manager

+91 8939432182 | thisisvarshasathya@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#)

CONTACT

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[LinkedIn](#)

EDUCATION

Humber College, Longo School of Business
Graduate Certificate in Fashion Management
Toronto Sept 2023 - Aug 2024
National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT) Bachelor of Design, Fashion Design
Chennai July 2016 - July 2020

SKILLS

Assortment Planning & OTB
Built buy plans and managed open-to-buy across 25+ subcategories · delivering ₹3.5 lakh revenue in two months.
Advanced Excel
Deployed dashboards · VLOOKUP · and pivot tables to track inventory health · sell-through · and supplier delivery performance.
Vendor Management
Coordinated PO/PI across 20+ suppliers and 10+ factories · achieving 95% on-time delivery and improving product margins from 22% to 35%.
Category Management
Launched women's western-wear brand generating ₹50 · 000 revenue with zero returns; expanded fashion category from 5 to 25+ subcategories.
Cross-Functional Collaboration
Partnered with design · marketing · and supply chain to align assortment plans with omnichannel merchandising goals.

PROFILE

NIFT graduate with 4+ years in fashion buying and merchandising, owning P&L for a category that grew from 5 to 25+ subcategories and delivered ₹3.5 lakh revenue in two months.
Improved product margins from 22% to 35% through direct vendor negotiations across 20+ suppliers, while maintaining 95% on-time delivery across 10+ factories.
Launched a women's western-wear brand generating ₹50,000 revenue with zero returns, demonstrating end-to-end range planning and assortment execution.
Experienced in omnichannel merchandising across online and offline channels, using Advanced Excel (pivot tables, VLOOKUP, dashboards) to analyze sell-through and optimize inventory.
Proven ability to assess OTB and inventory health, analyze sell-through data for markdown decisions, and resolve supplier bottlenecks, ready to drive H&M's category performance from day one.

EXPERIENCE

Category Manager - Fashion

SuperK, Bangalore, India
Nov 2025 - Present

Built the fashion category from near zero across online channels and a tech-enabled retail network of 3+ stores, launching 25+ subcategories and generating ₹3.5 lakh revenue in two months. Improved product margins from 22% to 35% through vendor negotiations, managing P&L and driving data-led merchandising decisions. Managed PO/PI coordination across 20+ suppliers and 10+ factories, achieving 95% on-time delivery and ensuring seamless assortment availability. Launched a women's western-wear brand that delivered ₹50,000 revenue with zero returns, demonstrating strong assortment planning and trend knowledge.

- Expanded fashion assortment from 5 to 25+ subcategories across menswear, womenswear, kidswear, footwear, and accessories by onboarding 12+ regional vendors, identifying assortment gaps, and benchmarking against value retailers like DMart and Vishal Mega Mart.
- Analyzed weekly sales performance, pricing benchmarks, and customer demand signals to generate ₹3.5 lakh in category revenue within two months.
- Negotiated vendor pricing, MOQs, and sourcing terms, improving product margins from 22% to 35% while maintaining competitive retail pricing.
- Partnered with marketing teams to launch fashion-led campaigns during New Year, Pongal, and Republic Day, increasing category visibility by ~22% and driving ~15% uplift in campaign period sales.
- Collaborated with operations and supply chain teams to improve stock availability for fast-moving SKUs, coordinating warehouse invoicing and inventory flow to reduce stock-outs by ~20% across priority products.
- Utilized Excel and Metabase dashboards for tracking sell-through, AOV, and margin performance; identified underperforming SKUs and implemented assortment rationalization that improved category gross margin by ~6%.